

Business Development Executive – Screening Test

For Undergraduate (UG) Candidates | 40 Questions | 40 Marks | Suggested Time: 40–45 Minutes

Candidate Name: _____ Date: _____
College: _____ Contact: _____

Instructions: Select the most appropriate answer for each question. The test evaluates sales fundamentals, lead generation, CRM, calling, communication, business development, customer handling, follow-ups, targets and sales metrics.

Section A – Sales Fundamentals

1. What is the primary objective of a Business Development Executive?

- A. Managing employee attendance
- B. Generating business and developing customer relationships
- C. Preparing financial statements
- D. Managing office administration

2. What does a sales funnel represent?

- A. Employee promotion stages
- B. Stages a prospect moves through before becoming a customer
- C. Accounting procedures
- D. Inventory movement

3. What is a prospect?

- A. An existing employee
- B. A potential customer who may purchase a product or service
- C. A competitor
- D. A supplier

4. What is upselling?

- A. Selling a lower-priced product
- B. Encouraging a customer to purchase a higher-value version or additional features
- C. Cancelling a sale
- D. Generating employee referrals

5. What is cross-selling?

- A. Selling complementary products/services to an existing customer
- B. Reducing the product price
- C. Contacting competitors
- D. Closing a lead

6. Which skill is essential for successful sales?

- A. Active listening
- B. Avoiding questions
- C. Speaking continuously
- D. Ignoring customer concerns

7. Why is product knowledge important for a BDE?

- A. It helps answer customer questions and communicate value accurately
- B. It eliminates the need for customer interaction
- C. It guarantees every sale
- D. It is only required by managers

8. What is a sales target?

- A. A company's office expense
- B. A measurable sales objective to be achieved within a specified period
- C. A customer complaint

D. A recruitment requirement

Section B – Lead Generation & CRM

9. What is lead generation?

- A. Finding and attracting potential customers
- B. Preparing payroll
- C. Managing leave records
- D. Preparing tax returns

10. Which can be a source of sales leads?

- A. Referrals
- B. Social media
- C. Website enquiries
- D. All of the above

11. What is a qualified lead?

- A. Any person with a phone number
- B. A lead that meets relevant criteria and shows potential interest or need
- C. An existing employee
- D. A competitor's employee

12. Why should lead information be maintained in a CRM?

- A. To track customer details, interactions, status and follow-ups
- B. To replace all sales calls
- C. To reduce product quality
- D. To manage employee attendance

13. Which information should normally be recorded for a sales lead?

- A. Contact details
- B. Requirement and lead status
- C. Follow-up date
- D. All of the above

14. A lead has not responded to one call. What is the best next step?

- A. Mark it as permanently lost immediately
- B. Follow up appropriately through a suitable channel and at a suitable time
- C. Call every five minutes
- D. Delete the lead

15. Which lead is generally a higher-priority opportunity?

- A. A prospect with a clear need, decision authority and near-term requirement
- B. A random contact with no interest
- C. An invalid phone number
- D. An unrelated person

16. What does lead conversion mean?

- A. Turning a qualified opportunity into a customer or desired business outcome
- B. Changing a customer's phone number
- C. Creating an employee ID
- D. Closing the CRM

Section C – Calling & Communication

17. What is the purpose of a cold call?

- A. To create an initial business conversation with a potential customer
- B. To guarantee an immediate sale

- C. To collect employee attendance
- D. To discuss unrelated topics

18. Which is an appropriate opening for a professional sales call?

- A. Buy our product immediately.
- B. Hello, I'm calling from _____. May I know if this is a convenient time to speak?
- C. You must purchase this.
- D. Listen to me without questions.

19. A prospect says, "I'm not interested." What should the BDE do?

- A. Argue with the prospect
- B. Politely explore the reason, if appropriate, and respond to the concern
- C. Repeatedly call without permission
- D. Insult the prospect

20. What is active listening?

- A. Listening carefully, understanding the customer and responding appropriately
- B. Waiting for your turn to speak
- C. Reading a script without listening
- D. Interrupting frequently

21. If a customer asks something you do not know, what should you do?

- A. Invent an answer
- B. Acknowledge it and confirm that you will verify and provide the correct information
- C. Avoid the customer
- D. End the relationship

22. Which tone is most suitable for a professional sales call?

- A. Polite, confident and helpful
- B. Aggressive and impatient
- C. Casual and dismissive
- D. Uninterested

23. Why should a BDE ask discovery questions?

- A. To understand the customer's needs, challenges, budget or decision process
- B. To make the call longer
- C. To avoid listening
- D. To collect unrelated personal information

24. Which is an example of a good closing question?

- A. So, shall we proceed with the next step?
- B. Why haven't you bought yet?
- C. You will buy, right?
- D. Can I call you every hour?

Section D – Business Development & Customer Handling

25. What is business development mainly concerned with?

- A. Creating and developing opportunities for business growth
- B. Only processing salaries
- C. Only handling office administration
- D. Only preparing invoices

26. Why is market research useful to a BDE?

- A. It helps understand customers, competitors and market opportunities
- B. It removes the need for sales

- C. It guarantees every prospect will buy
- D. It is unrelated to business development

27. A competitor offers a lower price. What should the BDE do first?

- A. Immediately promise a discount
- B. Understand the customer's priorities and communicate relevant value
- C. Criticize the competitor
- D. End the discussion

28. What helps build long-term customer relationships?

- A. Trust, consistent communication and delivering promised value
- B. Making unrealistic promises
- C. Contacting only when a sale is needed
- D. Hiding product limitations

29. A customer has a complaint about a service. What should the BDE do?

- A. Listen, acknowledge the concern, gather facts and coordinate an appropriate resolution
- B. Blame the customer
- C. Ignore the complaint
- D. End the relationship

30. What is a customer referral?

- A. An existing customer recommending a potential customer
- B. A competitor's advertisement
- C. An employee attendance record
- D. A product invoice

31. Why is competitor awareness useful in sales?

- A. It helps the BDE understand alternatives and communicate relevant differentiation accurately
- B. It allows false claims about competitors
- C. It eliminates customer needs
- D. It replaces product knowledge

32. Which approach is most appropriate when a customer has a limited budget?

- A. Understand the requirement and explore suitable options within the customer's constraints
- B. Pressure the customer to overspend
- C. Promise an unauthorized discount
- D. End the conversation immediately

Section E – Follow-ups, Targets & Metrics

33. Why are follow-ups important?

- A. They help maintain engagement and move suitable opportunities toward a decision
- B. Customers always buy on the first call
- C. They replace product knowledge
- D. They are only for complaints

34. A BDE has 100 leads and 20 customers purchase. What is the conversion rate?

- A. 5%
- B. 10%
- C. 20%
- D. 50%

35. A monthly target is ■5,00,000 and sales achieved are ■3,50,000. What amount remains?

- A. ■1,00,000
- B. ■1,25,000

C. ■1,50,000

D. ■2,00,000

36. Which metric measures the percentage of leads that become customers?

A. Conversion rate

B. Attendance rate

C. Attrition rate

D. Inventory turnover

37. A prospect requests a follow-up next Monday. What should you do?

A. Record the date and contact the prospect as agreed

B. Forget the request

C. Call repeatedly before Monday

D. Close the lead immediately

38. You have 50 leads and only two hours for follow-ups. How should you prioritize?

A. Randomly

B. Based on qualification, interest, urgency, potential value and agreed follow-up commitments

C. Only the newest leads

D. Only the first ten leads

39. You have made many calls but conversions are low. What should you review?

A. Lead quality, pitch, objections, follow-up process and customer feedback

B. Only the customer's behaviour

C. Nothing; continue exactly the same

D. Only the office timings

40. During a sales call, a customer says, "I need to discuss this with my manager." What is the best response?

A. Pressure them to decide immediately

B. Ask what information they need for the discussion and agree on a suitable follow-up

C. Mark the lead as lost

D. Stop contacting them permanently

Answer Key – HR / Recruitment Use

1. B	2. B	3. B	4. B	5. A
6. A	7. A	8. B	9. A	10. D
11. B	12. A	13. D	14. B	15. A
16. A	17. A	18. B	19. B	20. A
21. B	22. A	23. A	24. A	25. A
26. A	27. B	28. A	29. A	30. A
31. A	32. A	33. A	34. C	35. C
36. A	37. A	38. B	39. A	40. B

Suggested Screening Criteria

34–40: Strong understanding of sales and business development fundamentals

28–33: Good potential; proceed to interview/communication round

20–27: Consider based on communication and practical interview performance

Below 20: Requires further evaluation before proceeding

HR Recommendation: Conduct a short mock sales-call round after the written test to assess communication, confidence, active listening, objection handling and closing skills.